NADIA BRENNAN-AZIZ

Senior Site Reliability / Platform Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior SRE and platform engineer with 10 years of infrastructure experience, including six years running Kubernetes platforms on AWS. Experienced in hands-on cloud infrastructure engineering, Terraform, platform design and operation, and leading technical work across product and platform teams. Builds reliable, observable platforms and self-service infrastructure that help teams deploy and operate services effectively.

CORE SKILLS

Cloud infrastructure: AWS (EKS, EC2, VPC, IAM, RDS, S3, SQS, Route 53, CloudFront), cloud environment design and operation
Infrastructure as code: Terraform, Atlantis, Crossplane
Platforms and deployment: Kubernetes, Helm, Kustomize, Argo CD, Karpenter, GitHub Actions
Reliability and observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Alertmanager, OpenTelemetry, SLOs and error budgets, incident management
Programming and systems: Go, Python, Bash, Linux, Puppet
Testing: k6

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Platform Engineer | Tallybrook Ltd (B2B accounting SaaS) | Manchester / remote *Apr 2022 – Present*

- Tech lead for a five-person platform team operating an AWS EKS platform across eight clusters and three regions, supporting approximately 350 services.
- Designed and built an internal developer platform with Go and Python service templates, Argo CD GitOps, and Crossplane self-service for RDS, SQS and S3. Adopted by all 14 product teams; reduced the time for a new service to reach production from approximately two weeks to under one day.
- Led the move from cluster-autoscaler managed node groups to Karpenter, using Spot instances for stateless workloads with interruption handling. Reduced EC2 spend by 38% (approximately £410,000 per year).
- Introduced SLOs and burn-rate alerts for the 20 most critical services, with error-budget policy agreed with product leadership. Reduced on-call pages per week by approximately 60%.
- Serve in the incident commander rotation and established incident and post-mortem processes.

Site Reliability Engineer | Brightwater Games | Leeds *Jan 2019 – Mar 2022*

- Operated AWS game-backend infrastructure (EC2, ECS and later EKS) for titles with up to 1.2 million daily active players.
- Managed infrastructure as code in Terraform across approximately 40 modules, using Atlantis for plan and apply through pull requests.
- Replaced a noisy Nagios setup with a Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager and Loki observability stack.
- Ran k6 load tests and launch-day capacity planning, including tests simulating 300,000 concurrent players; identified and helped resolve a connection-pool limit before launch.

Linux Systems Engineer | Pennine Hosting | Sheffield *Jul 2016 – Dec 2018*

- Managed approximately 600 Linux servers for hosting customers using Puppet configuration management.
- Automated operational tasks with Bash and Python and provided on-call support for customer incidents.

SELECTED PROJECT

Kubernetes preview namespace cleanup operator | Open source side project *2024*

- Built a small Go Kubernetes controller using controller-runtime to delete expired preview namespaces; received approximately 120 GitHub stars.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science | University of the North Moors | 2016

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) | 2021; renewed 2024
AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional | 2023

ADDITIONAL

Speaker, UK DevOps meetup (2024): “SLOs that product managers care about”
Mentored three engineers transitioning from backend engineering into SRE
Languages: English (native), Urdu (conversational)